CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 11

Darcy *Wickliffe*

VESPER'S YOUNGER COUSIN AND HEIR

"Everyone calls you the heir. Nobody ever asks whether you want the job."



FOR DARCY WICKLIFFE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

CORE CHARACTER

IN EVERY GAME

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

"The Golden Sun": yellow or gold clothes and a sunburst of paper rays around your face. Dot gold face paint freckles across your nose.

Mask: a gold paper half mask, or yellow card with two eye holes.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

BACKGROUND

You love Candlewick Hall, but you have never wanted to run it. Your bicycle repair shop in the Hollow closed in the spring and left you owing $4,000. You have told nobody, not even Vesper, until tonight.

YOUR SECRET

Right after the 8:15 toast you asked Vesper, quietly, by the ballroom doors, for a loan. Vesper said, “Not tonight, Darcy. After nine you’ll understand.” You are afraid the announcement cuts you out of the Hall altogether, and people saw your face fall.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

At 8:15 you heard the toast. From 8:30 to 8:45 you stood in the Costume Parade line-up on the ballroom stage as entrant No. 2 and never left it. At about 8:48 you saw the Lantern Ghost through the ballroom windows. At 9:00 you and Hadley went to fetch Vesper and found Vesper asleep in the window chair, the pumpkin cup on the sill. Vesper never woke up.

YOUR GOALS

- Prove you never left the stage line between 8:30 and 8:45.
- Keep the loan and your debt quiet until Round 2.
- Find out what Vesper was going to announce.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You saw the Lantern Ghost at about 8:48 from the stage: a small light drifting past the gallery windows, one after another, then gone. At 9:00 you and Hadley found Vesper in the window chair with the pumpkin cup on the sill. Tell people Vesper seemed distracted at the toast. Keep the loan to yourself for now.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Where were you working tonight, and did anyone keep you company?"
- Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Why were you already near the gallery when we went to fetch Vesper?"

YOUR TASK

> Find out who wore a fox mask tonight, and who else wore a long black cloak.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Admit the argument: after the toast you asked Vesper for a loan, and Vesper said, "Not tonight. After nine you'll understand." Point out that the parade line-up sheet (Evidence #7) shows you on the stage from 8:30 to 8:45. Entrants were not allowed to leave the line.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

- Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Who could have known your mask was hanging on hook 3?"
- Ask **Perry Lanthorn:** "Do the letters "Pe" on that torn supply slip stand for you?"

YOUR TASK

> Get Briar to confirm out loud that you never left the stage line.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Three people have their own key to the Back Stairs door: you (family), Marlo (the workshop keys) and Perry (the lantern keys). You have never heard of Hollow Antiques. Last month Vesper told you, "Marlo dusts those brass molds every week. Nobody else touches them."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Who looks after the brass molds in the display case?"

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "What else did Vesper's notes for nine o'clock say?"

YOUR TASK

> Look closely at everyone's gold face paint. Whose is smudged around the eyes?

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade